



Barcelona
2026

Capital Mundial
de l'Arquitectura

PARLOUR GARDENS

DREAMS FROM THE ROOFTOP



PRESS RELEASE

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE
3 AUGUST 2026

A CENTURY OF GARDEN THINKING

BARCELONA BOTANICAL GARDEN · JUNE-OCTOBER 2026

PARLOUR GARDENS: DREAMS FROM THE ROOFTOP

Barcelona will host one of the most compelling design exhibitions of 2026: *Parlour Gardens: Dreams from the Rooftop*, a landmark project bringing together fifteen ceramic garden models — one original from 1927 and fourteen new commissions — at the Barcelona Botanical Garden on Montjuïc from June to September. The exhibition is a core component of the UNESCO–UIA World Capital of Architecture 2026 official programme, selected through an open call and fully funded by Barcelona City Council.

Fourteen internationally recognised landscape architects and architects, working across all five Mediterranean-homoclimatic climate regions of the globe — California, Chile, South Africa, Australia, and the Mediterranean basin — have each created an original ceramic garden model. Together they enter into dialogue with a historic piece: a *jardin de saló* conceived in 1926 by architect Nicolau M. Rubió i Tudurí, ceramicist Josep Llorens Artigas, and French Fauvist painter Raoul Dufy, first exhibited at the Bernheim-Jeune galleries in Paris in 1927.

Each contemporary model has been realised in glazed ceramic — combining advanced direct 3D ceramic printing with traditional craft techniques — by Martí Baltà and his team at Barcelona 3D Ceramics, and planted with living Mediterranean species curated by horticulture specialist Enric Sancho of Cultidelta.

“TO GIVE THE IMAGINATIVE THE PLEASURES OF THE GARDEN, SOMETHING REAL ON WHICH TO REST THEIR DREAMS, I IMAGINED TINY CERAMIC GARDENS, DECORATED BY RAOUL DUFY AND FIRED BY JOSEP LLORENS ARTIGAS.”

– NICOLAU M. RUBIÓ I TUDURÍ, 1926

EXHIBITION

Barcelona has been designated UNESCO–UIA World Capital of Architecture for 2026 — the first city to hold this title in the congress’s modern form. *Parlour Gardens: Dreams from the Rooftop* is presented as a unique multidisciplinary intersection of art, technology, architecture, and landscape design.

Its home, the Barcelona Botanical Garden — a 14-hectare ecological showcase on Montjuïc designed by Carlos Ferrater, Josep Lluís Canosa, and Beth Figueras for the 1992 Olympics — organises flora into homoclimatic zones mirroring the climates from which the invited designers come. Each model is placed in the sector of the garden that echoes its creator’s home region.

The exhibition employs a *déballage* strategy: each model is presented directly on its wooden transport crate, making visible the materiality of displacement and the journey each object has made. Fifteen models, fifteen journeys, one garden.

KEY FACTS

VENUE

Barcelona Botanical Garden, Montjuïc

DATES

June – September 2026

PROGRAMME

UNESCO–UIA World Capital of Architecture 2026

FUNDING

Barcelona City Council (open call)

MODELS

15 (1 original 1927 + 14 new commissions)

STUDIOS

14 teams from 9 countries

CLIMATE REGIONS

California, Chile, South Africa, Australia, Mediterranean

PUBLIC PROGRAMME

3 round tables + Talks and Walks tours

UNPACKED, ON SITE

Each ceramic model arrives crated, labelled with its designer, and is shown directly on that transport crate — the déballage strategy that makes the journey part of the work. Images from the Talks and Walks tours.



JAMES CORNER — TOPOGRAPHY



KAMEL LOUAFI — MEDITERRANEAN



CATHERINE MOSBACH —
MEDITERRANEAN



ADAM GREENSPAN — CALIFORNIA



PHIL HARRIS — AUSTRALIA



JAMES CORNER — STARFLOWER



JAMES CORNER — ALVEOLI



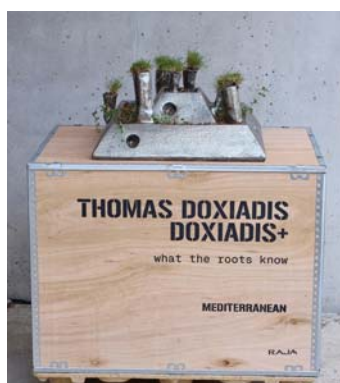
PETER STUTCHBURY — AUSTRALIA



TARNA KLITZNER — SOUTH AFRICA



TERESA MOLLER — CHILE



THOMAS DOXIADIS — GREECE



ADRIAN MCGREGOR — AUSTRALIA



WALTER HOOD — CALIFORNIA



GARETH DOHERTY — AFRICA



AIDA CORTÉS & MARIA BUHIGAS, OPENI



OVERLOOKING BARCELONA, MONTJUÏC

14 STUDIOS, 9 COUNTRIES

SOUTHERN AUSTRALIA

Adrian McGregor / McGregor & Coxall
 Peter Stutchbury Architecture
 Phil Harris / Troppo Architects

MEDITERRANEAN

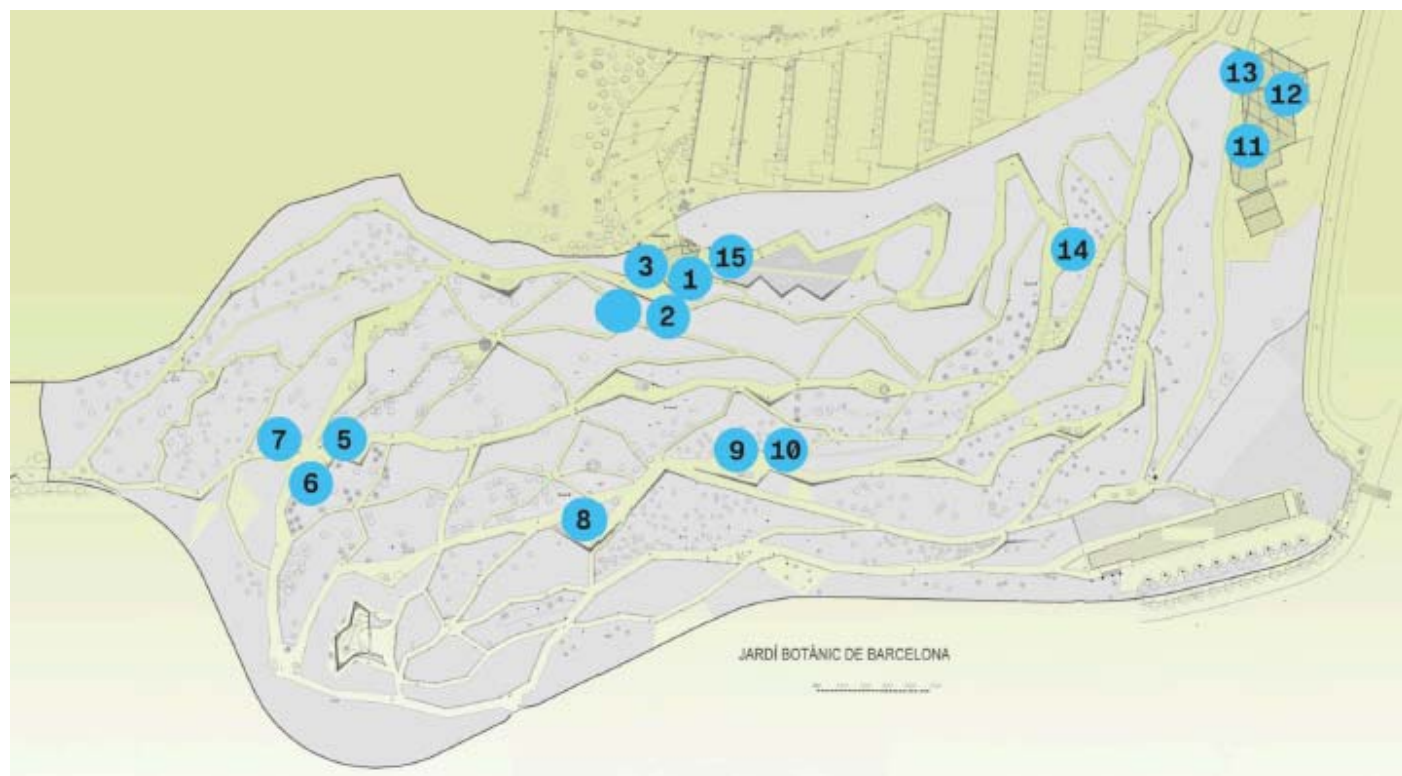
Catherine Mosbach / France
 Thomas Doxiadis / Greece
 Jala Makhzoumi & Abdul-Halim Jabr /
 Lebanon–Egypt
 Kamel Louafi / Algeria–Germany
 Teresa Moller / Chile

CALIFORNIA, USA

James Corner / Field Operations
 Adam Greenspan / PWP Landscape Architecture
 Walter Hood / Hood Design Studio

AFRICA

Gareth Doherty / Critical Landscapes
 Design Lab
 Tarna Klitzner & Lovell Friendman / TK
 Landscape Architecture



The Barcelona Botanical Garden, reclaimed from a former landfill on Montjuïc for the 1992 Olympics, organises flora into homoclimatic zones: California, Chile, South Africa, Australia and the Mediterranean.

ROUND TABLES

05.06

6 PM

Art, Nature and Contemporary Expression: One Hundred Years of Salon Gardens.

With James Corner (USA), Tarna Klitzner (South Africa), Thomas Doxiadis (Greece), and Peter Stutchbury (Australia). Moderated by Marina Cervera. Free admission with prior registration.



27.06

6 PM

Architecture, Landscaping and Urban Resilience: The Garden as Interdisciplinary Practice.

With Kamel Louafi (Algeria/Germany), Adam Greenspan (USA), Phil Harris (Australia), Catherine Mosbach (France), and Jala Makhzoumi (Lebanon). On the eve of the UIA World Congress of Architects Barcelona 2026. Moderated by Marina Cervera and José Luis Cortés. Free admission with prior registration.



04.10

11 AM

Technologies, Climate Adaptation and Botanical Research: Gardens for the Future.

Closing session with Adrian McGregor (Australia), Walter Hood (USA), Teresa Moller (Chile), and Gareth Doherty (Ireland/USA). Moderated by James Hayter. Free admission. Closes with a presentation of the pieces' international itinerary to botanical gardens in homoclimatic Mediterranean climates worldwide.

TALKS AND WALKS

Throughout the exhibition, Parlour Gardens presents Talks and Walks, a series of guided tours through the Barcelona Botanical Garden designed to ignite conversation around nature, landscape and architecture. Led by members of the curatorial and design team, each walk moves between the fifteen ceramic models in their homoclimatic settings, opening an informal, on-site dialogue between visitors, gardens and the ideas that shaped them.

FULL SCHEDULE & REGISTRATION:

[PARLOURGARDENS.NABLABCN.COM/WALKSANDTALKS.HTML](https://parlourgardens.nablabcn.com/walksandtalks.html)



MARINA CERVERA

PROJECT DIRECTOR · CEO OF NABLABCN · DIRECTOR, BARCELONA
INTERNATIONAL LANDSCAPE BIENNIAL

Cervera conceived the project and led the process from concept to realisation, selecting participating designers within a homoclimatic framework and coordinating the exhibition's spatial and botanical dimensions. She worked directly alongside the Barcelona 2026 World Capital of Architecture team, the Botanical Garden and the ceramic studio.



Introducing the first
round table, 5 June 2026

JAMES HAYTER

IFLA PAST PRESIDENT · FOUNDING PARTNER, OXIGEN

Past President of the International Federation of Landscape Architects. Hayter connects Parlour Gardens to the global landscape architecture community, bringing decades of experience in cross-cultural practice and professional leadership.

JOSÉ LUIS CORTÉS

UIA PAST PRESIDENT · PAST PRESIDENT, INTERNATIONAL UNION
OF ARCHITECTS

Cortés anchors Parlour Gardens within the architectural ecosystem mobilised by the UIA congress and the official Barcelona 2026 World Capital of Architecture programme.



MARTÍ BALTÀ

CERAMIC REALISATION DIRECTOR, BARCELONA
3D CERAMICS

Responsible for the ceramic realisation of all pieces, combining craft knowledge with advanced direct 3D ceramic printing technology.

JAUME PASCUAL

PLANTING & PLANT CARE DIRECTOR, TALIO SA

Technical agricultural engineer with over 25 years of field experience, responsible for installation and ongoing maintenance of all living planting.

HELIA GARCÍA

GREEN ADVISOR

Landscape architect with 26+ years of experience, co-founder of Liquidambar and Verdalis, advising on the selection and care of living species.

ÀURIA MERCADÉ

WEB DEVELOPMENT

Built and maintains parlourgardens.nablabcn.com.
1redpandauria618 on GitHub.

ENRIC SANCHO

PLANT SPECIES & LIVING GARDEN
ADVISORY, CULTIDELTA

Curated the botanical programme for each model, ensuring every planting scheme is ecologically coherent and true to each designer's vision.

MONTSE CORTÉS

GRAPHIC DESIGN & VIDEO

Technical architect and neuroarchitect bringing together graphic communication, video and a deep understanding of space as something to be lived.

LOTEMA MUNTATGES

INSTALLATION, DISMANTLING & TRANSPORT

Specialists in the conception and execution of exhibitions, ensuring every element is assembled and presented with precision and care.

Special Acknowledgement: the photographs of the jardi de saló painted by Nicolau M. Rubió i Tudurí and produced by Ceràmiques Serra are reproduced with the kind permission of the Serra family — his last creative work, completed at the request of the 1979 Fundació Joan Miró exhibition. Thanks also to Josep Ramon Reventós, Marta Cervelló and Montse Rivero for historical assessment and archival images.

Press coverage has been central to carrying Parlour Gardens beyond Barcelona and into the international architecture and landscape architecture communities the project was conceived to speak to. Two outlets have been particularly significant:

ARCHDAILY

One of the most widely read architecture platforms in the world. Coverage places Parlour Gardens directly in front of the global architecture profession the UNESCO–UIA programme is designed to engage.

LANDEZINE

The leading international showcase for landscape architecture. Reinforces the project's credibility with the landscape design audience the participating studios belong to.

SELECTED PRESS LINKS

- [ArchDaily](#) — *Parlour Gardens Exhibition Displays Miniature Ceramic Landscapes at Barcelona's Botanic Garden*, 31 Jul 2026
- [Landezine](#) — *Parlour Gardens: Dreams From the Rooftop*
- [Catpaisatge.net](#) — *Butlletí 1887*
- [Salama Magazine](#) — salama-mag.com/11722-2
- [Coolture Magazine](#) — *'Parlour Gardens' reinterpreta los jardines de salón*, 9 Jun 2026
- [Eventole](#) — *Exposició: Jardins de salón*
- [AEPASAJISTAS](#) — *Proyecto expositivo y Mesas redondas*, 4 Jun 2026
- [Ajuntament de Barcelona](#) — *Barcelona Capital Mundial de l'Arquitectura*
- [La Vanguardia](#) — *8 exposiciones para redescubrir la arquitectura de Barcelona*
- [Museu de Ciències Naturals de Barcelona](#) — *The Botanical Garden hosts 'Jardins de Saló'*
- [Mailchimp / COAC](#) — *This June, Barcelona is the centre of the architecture world*
- [YouTube](#) — *Video recording, second round table*, 27 Jun 2026

MEDIA CONTACT

Parlour Gardens — NablaBCN
Barcelona, Spain

parlourgardens.nablabcn.com

Notes to editors: high-resolution images, designer portraits and exhibition visuals available on request. Exhibition design and museography by NablaBCN Studio SCP, winner of the New European Bauhaus Prize for the Carrer Girona Green Axis.

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